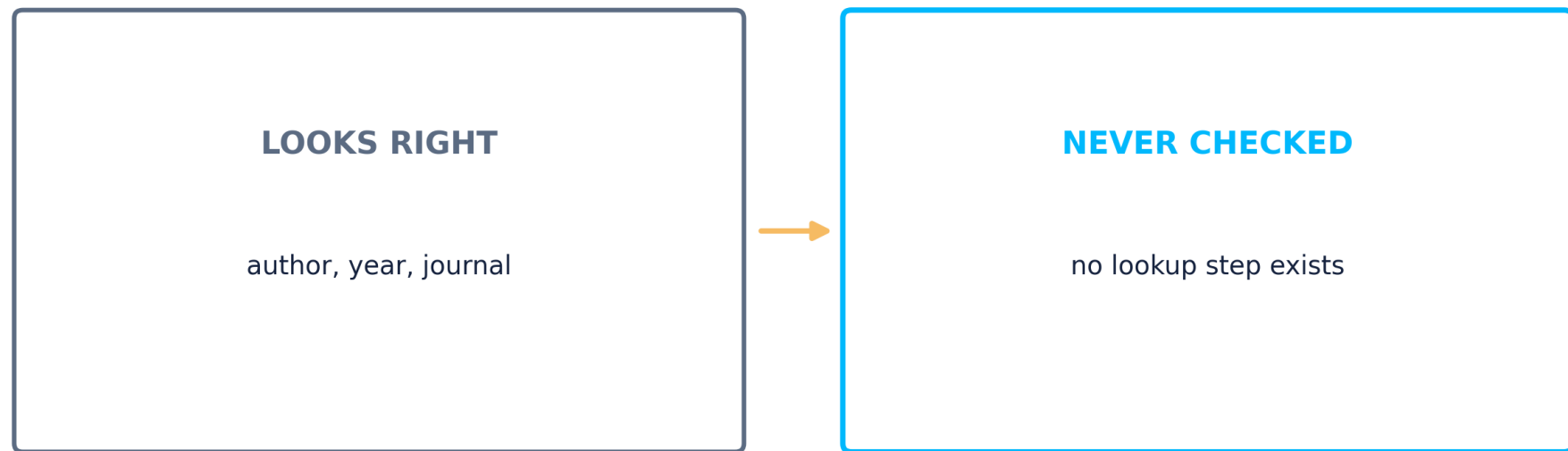


Why it invents citations



Plausible shape, no lookup step

A made-up reference is not a lie. It is the model doing **exactly what it was built to do**.

- 1 It predicts text that *looks* like a citation — author, year, journal.
- 2 A plausible-looking fake scores as well as a real one during prediction.
- 3 It has no lookup step, so nothing checks whether the paper exists.

REMEMBER

Never accept a citation you have not opened. This failure is structural.

